seventeenth century. Translated roughly as "troubles within, dangers without," the saying recognized the intimate relation between domestic and foreign policy.

As a cardinal virtue of national strategy, it was accepted that a country that could not control what happened at its borders also could not control what happened within them. Even if Japan had to accommodate and drop the more restrictive maritime exclusion edicts, maintaining a distance from the world remained both a strategy and a national goal. In ways perhaps not fully appreciated, that tension between openness and insularity continued to influence Japanese history and government policy throughout the modern period, up to the present.

In some respects, Japan appears to have enshrined a form of "exclusionary nationalism." As used by scholars with respect to the European state-building experience, exclusionary nationalism was the means of forming modern, unified nation-states by the suppression of domestic minorities, particularly religious minorities.[1] Exclusionary nationalism has come to be used to explain not only ethnic conflict but also the racist nature of some modern European rightist parties such as France's National Front.[2] Even more recently, the concept of "national conservatism" has been championed by some on the American right who seek to privilege the concept of the nation and its particularistic culture over internationalism (even of the conservative variety) and cosmopolitanism.[3]

Yet Japan is exclusionarily nationalistic essentially due to its particular history, not simply by a conscious or overtly political choice. An island nation, its continental and Pacific island lineage groups long ago merged into one unified ethnicity, with long-term resident foreigners making up a negligible part of its population. The largest group of "foreigners" in Japan remains ethnic Koreans, many descended from those forcibly brought to Japan during the decades of colonization that ended in 1945. Being thus in their second or third generation of residence in Japan, these ethnic Koreans are usually indistinguishable from Japanese, and most consider themselves to be full members of the society. Nonetheless, Korean immigrants and their descendants have been